Wenbo Chen

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Education

Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies August 2023–May 2025
M.A. in International Relations, with Honors (top 10%)
GPA: 3.9/4.0. Focus areas: Macroeconomics and Quantitative Methods.

China Foreign Affairs University August 2019–July 2023
B.Sc. in Financial Economics; Minor in Diplomacy
Grade: 88.23/100. Outstanding Graduate of Beijing Municipality, 2023 (top 5%).

London School of Economics and Political Science September 2021–June 2022
Visiting Undergraduate Student

Research Interests

Macroeconomics; monetary policy and firm productivity; energy and environmental economics.

Research in Progress

Supply-Driven Monetary Mechanism Ongoing
Coauthored with Deniz Igan, Gee Hee Hong, and Galip Kemal Ozhan
Study how monetary policy affects productivity through firm entry and exit, market competition, and resource allocation, and how regulation shapes these transmission channels.

- Process more than 200 million firm-year observations across over 30 countries using SQL Server and Stata; integrate Orbis and CompNet data and construct 15 financial and structural variables.
- Estimate productivity for more than 50 million firms using the Wooldridge (2009) GMM estimator and assemble a harmonized cross-country panel.
- Construct Taylor-rule-based monetary policy stance measures and estimate heterogeneous productivity responses using local projections with high-dimensional fixed effects.
- Design empirical tests of firm entry and exit, regulatory heterogeneity, and monetary policy asymmetry to examine the mechanisms linking monetary policy and long-run productivity.

Local Effects of Data Center Construction Ongoing
Coauthored with Sandra Baquie, Yu Shi, Philip Baratt, Kez Hou, Zhao Zhang, and Weili Lin
Contributing to the April 2027 IMF World Economic Outlook, Chapter 2 (AI financing);
working paper in preparation.

- Construct a harmonized cross-country panel of high-frequency wholesale electricity prices and load to study the local effects of data center construction; standardize temporal frequency, currencies, and measurement units across markets.
- Develop five candidate geospatial instruments for data center capacity using Python and QGIS, linking facilities to fiber landing points, population density, water access, and more than 17,000 second-level administrative units across 26 countries.

Professional Experience

International Monetary Fund Washington, DC, United States
Research Department, World Economic Studies Division June 2025–Present
Research Analyst

- Conduct empirical analysis and develop reproducible cross-country data workflows for the *World Economic Outlook*, including analytical chapter research, using Stata, Python, EViews, and Excel.
- Harmonize macroeconomic data and produce research tables and figures; validate country-team forecasts and coordinate Common Surveillance Database submissions using Power BI.
- Coordinate weekly Article IV staff-report data submissions across the IMF's membership and maintain submission workflows using Power BI and Power Automate.
- Develop Python routines to check consistency across more than 100 large data files during a migration of the IMF's database platform.

Institute of International Finance Washington, DC, United States
Economic Research Department, Latin America Team January–May 2025
Research Assistant

- Coauthored an assessment of Latin American metals exporters' exposure to U.S. tariffs, external vulnerabilities, and policy responses; constructed over 100 commodity-country trade tables using Haver, UN Comtrade, and WTO Trade Analysis Online.
- Built a dynamic price tracker covering more than 100 commodities, with detailed breakdowns and visualizations, using Haver, Bloomberg, and UN Comtrade.

World Bank Brasília, Brazil
Macroeconomics, Trade and Investment Global Practice June–August 2024
Macroeconomics and Public Finance Intern

- Contributed to the renewable-energy chapter of an economic memorandum on Northeast Brazil; analyzed four power plants, investment trends, state fiscal incentives, and local socioeconomic spillovers using Tableau and Excel.
- Developed current-account and consumption forecasts and contributed to a GDP forecasting model, tracking more than 50 macroeconomic indicators in Stata and Excel.
- Contributed to the Brazil Green Public Finance Review by constructing and visualizing 30 years of state-level ICMS fuel-tax and transport-emissions data.
- Quantitatively examined relationships between Amazon forest degradation and Brazilian exports.

Selected Policy Report Contributions

IMF World Economic Outlook — research and data contributions

- April 2027, Chapter 2: AI financing, including research on the local effects of data center construction (*in progress*).
- April 2026, Chapter 1.
- January 2026 Update.
- October 2025, Chapter 1.
- July 2025 Update.

Teaching Experience

Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant
Instructor: Prof. Jaime Marquez.
Graduate courses: Quantitative Global Economics; Macro Econometrics: Time Series Analysis.

- Prepared IMF, Federal Reserve, and other macroeconomic data and Stata work files for student assignments.
- Led Stata, PcGive, and Excel workshops on data cleaning, VAR and VECM models, fixed-effects regressions, and policy simulations, with applications to oil prices, exchange rates, and Taylor rules.

Johns Hopkins University, Carey Business School Fall 2024–Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant
Instructor: Prof. Kwang Soo Cheong.
Graduate courses: Advanced Corporate Finance; Business Microeconomics and Investments.

- Recorded review sessions on economic and financial theory and Excel modeling, covering DCF and DDM valuation, portfolio optimization, the Fama–French three-factor model, capital structure, and market competition.
- Graded problem sets, Excel-based case studies, and midterm and final examinations.

China Foreign Affairs University Fall 2020–Spring 2021
School of International Economics; Institute of International Relations
Teaching Assistant
Undergraduate courses: Principles of Economics; Microeconomics.
Undergraduate and graduate course: Strategy and International Security.

- Answered student questions and graded weekly assignments and examinations for economics courses.

Honors and Awards

SAIS Dean's Scholarship, Johns Hopkins University ($20,000).
SAIS Summer Internship Grant and Summer Course Scholarship.
International Exchange Scholarship, China Foreign Affairs University, 2022 (CNY 150,000).

Academic Service

Ad hoc referee: *Economic Change and Restructuring*.

Skills and Qualifications

Research software: Stata, Python, R, SQL Server.

Modeling and geospatial tools: MATLAB/Dynare (working familiarity); QGIS.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent).

Standardized tests: GRE 334/340; Analytical Writing 5.5/6.0; IELTS 8.0/9.0.